

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Severe bleeding

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Call emergency services and press firmly directly on the bleeding wound with a dressing or clean cloth. Maintain pressure. For life-threatening bleeding from an arm or leg, use a commercial tourniquet if trained; follow dispatcher instructions.

Do now.

☐**Protect and call**

01

Check scene safety, use gloves if available and get emergency help.

☐**Apply direct pressure**

02

Press firmly over the wound and keep pressing until bleeding stops or appropriate help takes over.

☐**Use trained techniques**

03

Use a tourniquet or wound packing for the appropriate injury if trained, following the device and dispatcher instructions.

☐**Monitor the person**

04

Keep them from getting cold, check breathing and remain until responders arrive.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Maintain firm pressure and have another person arrange the safest reachable medical care. A tourniquet, if indicated and used, must stay in place until a medical professional takes over; note its application time. Do not keep releasing pressure to check whether bleeding has stopped.

Watch for.

Do not pull an embedded object out; press around it and get help.

People & practical needs.

Give someone the specific task of calling or locating care while another person provides first aid. Keep the patient warm or cool as the condition requires and record what happened and when

Next decision.

Get urgent medical assessment even if bleeding stops. Take a practical bleeding-control course.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Severe bleeding · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/severe-bleeding/>